

— PREPARED FOR KIM NGUYEN · VP, DIGITAL & CHANNELS · TELUS

Five new channels for your team to run — one **per AI system**, and each rewards a different playbook.

ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google AI Overview, and Google AI Mode are already **five distinct digital channels** to your customer — as different from each other as paid search is from affiliate, and each with a specific optimization signal. TELUS's aggregate **69/100** masks a 20-point spread across the five. This read gives your team the per-channel scoreboard, the profile of each channel's user, the intervention that moves each one, and the weekly rhythm that makes it operational.

— TELUS ACROSS THE FIVE CHANNELS

Gemini	76	<i>strongest</i>
Google AI Mode	76	<i>strongest</i>
Google AIO	72	<i>strong</i>
ChatGPT	66	<i>mid</i>
Perplexity	56	<i>weakest</i>

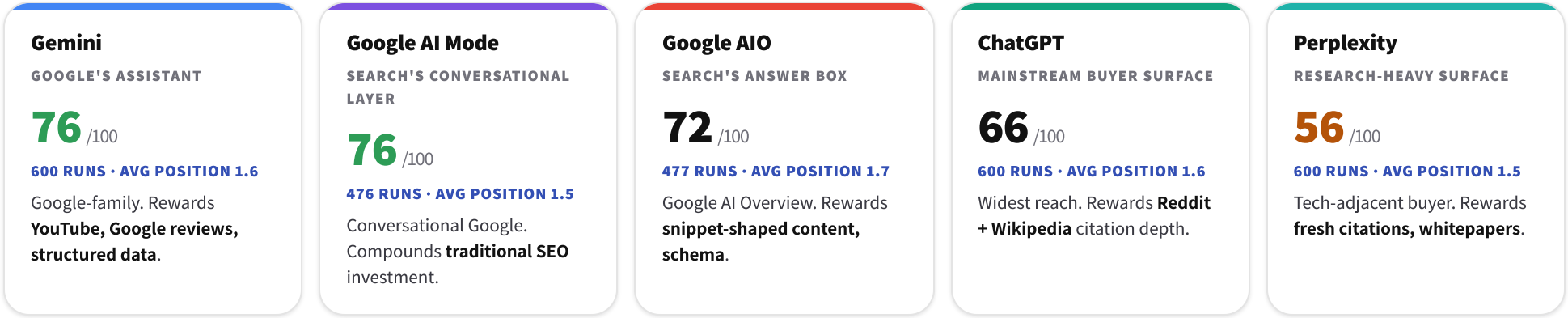
— WEEK 14 · WHAT SHIFTED · SEP 29 — OCT 5

Channel-signal week — bundles, flex-data, and 5G-vs-Bell all moved up.

- ▲ 2026 bundle deal 44 → 54 *bundle intent surfacing*
- ▲ Flexible mobile data 10 → 22 *monthly-adjust narrative starting*
- ▲ 5G vs Bell 55 → 63 *direct-comparison lift*

The five-channel scoreboard

Share-of-answer for TELUS across the five AI channels, thirty days ending October 5. Each channel's user base and citation logic is different — the score reflects both TELUS's presence in that channel's training data and the freshness signals it consults.



The 20-point read. The spread from Perplexity (56) to Gemini/AI Mode (76) is the story. Each channel is a different optimization stack — one team can't win them all with a single playbook. The channel-by-channel framing below is how your team's investment maps.

Each channel unpacked — who's on it, what wins it

Same measurement lens, per-channel view. This is how your team should map effort — different playbooks for different channels, like paid vs organic vs affiliate.

CHANNEL	SCORE	USER PROFILE · CITATION LOGIC	BEST-PERFORMING QUESTION	WEAKEST QUESTION	WHAT MOVES IT
Gemini	76	Google's assistant user. Skews Android, Google-Workspace, everyday consumer + SMB. Cites YouTube, Google reviews, Maps, structured data heavily.	Rural business reliability · TELUS 5G speed vs competitors · Business owner sentiment	Home-office wireline · Flexible mobile data	YouTube content, Google review velocity, structured-data hygiene. Same investments that lift Google SEO.
Google AI Mode	76	Google search users who opted into conversational. Broad consumer + SMB. Direct pull from Google's search index — SEO wins here first.	Reliability · rural service · 5G speed · customer service	Flex data · home-office wireline · SMB wireless	Entity-optimized SEO, comparison-site presence, freshness signals. Your search team's playbook, extended.
Google AIO	72	Every Google searcher. Highest-reach AI surface in Canada by user count. Snippet-formatted, cites 5-10 sources per answer.	Rural residents · business owners · positive TELUS customer service	Flex data · home-office wireline	Snippet-shaped content, FAQ schema, cite-worthy authoritative pages. Traditional SEO with GEO overlay.
ChatGPT	66	Widest-mainstream surface. ~500M weekly users globally, cross-demographic. Reddit-heavy citation logic. Wikipedia + top publishers as facts layer.	Rural reliability · TELUS satisfaction · positive service	Home-office wireline · flex data · SMB wireless · activation fees	Reddit & forum presence, Wikipedia hygiene, mainstream press placement. Not an SEO play — a discourse play.

CHANNEL	SCORE	USER PROFILE · CITATION LOGIC	BEST-PERFORMING QUESTION	WEAKEST QUESTION	WHAT MOVES IT
Perplexity	56	Research-heavy, tech-adjacent, enterprise DM. Prosumer, analyst, IT-buyer. Citations shown inline; freshness & authority weighted highest.	Rural residents · positive TELUS service · TELUS satisfaction	Weakest across the board — home-office wireline, flex data, activation fees, families	Third-party evidence (OpenSignal, IDC), current comparison-site listings, technical whitepapers. Cite- first mindset.

03

Two channels worth an operating decision this quarter

The 76 that compounds SEO investment (protect and extend), and the 56 that leaves a specific buyer profile on the table (close the gap).

■ COMPOUNDING CHANNEL Google-family surfaces reward SEO investment 2× Gemini (76) and Google AI Mode (76) both pull from Google's search index. Google AIO (72) does too. That means every dollar of SEO investment TELUS makes — entity optimization, structured data, page authority, freshness — compounds into three AI channels simultaneously. Your search team already runs this playbook. The operating decision is whether to add the AI-answer surface to their measurement rubric so wins there are tracked and rewarded, or leave them uncounted while the team optimizes for classic SERP. 3 AI channels lift with SEO 1,553 weekly runs (Gemini+AIO+Mode) 74.7 avg score across the three			■ GAP CHANNEL Perplexity's user profile is the enterprise buyer Perplexity's users skew tech-adjacent, analyst, IT-decision-maker. It's not a mass channel — but it's the one where SMB IT leads and mid-market decision-makers do research. TELUS at 56 versus 76 on Gemini means a specific buyer profile is seeing competitors more than TELUS in the answer. Perplexity weights freshness and authoritative citations — recent third-party evidence, comparison-site listings, whitepapers, OpenSignal reports. Not Reddit-driven like ChatGPT. A distinct playbook, and one where your team can move the number inside a quarter with a focused push. -20 points vs top channel Enterprise buyer profile 70 Q1 27 target		
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The weekly rhythm — what your team runs against the channels

One operating cadence, five channels visible in it. Same measurement lands every Monday; the working sessions after it are the difference between insight and action.

— MONDAY

Automated pull lands

Panel refresh across all 5 channels · deltas flagged inside 24h · dashboard update. **No human effort.**

— TUESDAY

Channel allocation session

Team meeting: which channel gets which intervention this week? **SEO team → Google-family. Community team → ChatGPT. Analyst-relations → Perplexity.**

— WEDNESDAY

Competitor delta review

Bell moves flagged per channel. Rogers stable-check. **Response briefed same day if a competitor gained >3 pts on a query.**

— FRIDAY

Operating detail to Kim

Per-channel score, per-query trend, cited sources, intervention log. **The working file.**

— MONTHLY

Executive read out

One page to Kevin, Katherine, David. **Same instrument, three consumers.** Kim's team owns the operating detail.

Five moves — one per channel

The interventions that shift each channel's score. Ordered by leverage against TELUS's current gap pattern.

MOVE	CHANNEL	WHAT RUNS	TARGET
1 Close the Perplexity gap with third-party evidence Comparison-site refresh (WhistleOut, PlanHub), OpenSignal & IDC citations, TELUS Business whitepapers optimized for citation.	Perplexity	Cite-first assets · quarterly refresh	56 → 70
2 Extend the SEO team's rubric to Google-family AI surfaces Add AI Mode + AIO scoring to the SEO team's weekly dashboard. Entity optimization becomes AEO-aware.	Gemini · AIO · AI Mode	Rubric extension · no new headcount	74.7 → 82
3 Fund a standing Reddit + community presence for ChatGPT Community-manager retainer, subreddit engagement (r/CanadianTelecom, r/TELUS, r/canadianISPs), forum.telus.com content velocity.	ChatGPT	1 FTE / partner · discourse-shaping	66 → 75
4 YouTube content sprint for Gemini TELUS 5G, rural coverage, business testimonials as short-form YouTube. Structured product page schema alignment.	Gemini	Content sprint · Q4 launch	76 → 82
5 Snippet-formatted FAQ content for Google AIO Rewrite priority telus.com/business pages with FAQ schema, direct-answer paragraphs, entity clarity.	Google AIO	Content optimization · 6-wk sprint	72 → 80

The operating summary

Kim's team runs the operating rhythm on all five AI channels weekly, with per-channel playbooks that map to existing team responsibilities (SEO, community, PR, comparison-site). One measurement infrastructure, five different intervention lanes, three executive consumers (Kevin's brand read, Katherine's SMB read, David's Telco Division read). **Position of maximum leverage:** your team becomes the operating layer for the entire answer surface, not one of many teams trying to influence it. Aggregate TELUS score moves from **69 → 75** by end of Q1 27 if the five moves land as a program.

ONE INSTRUMENT, FIVE CHANNELS, THREE CONSUMERS

Methodology, for the room

The panel. 20 realistic Canadian-telco buying questions asked every Monday of 5 AI systems — ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google AI Overview, Google AI Mode. Results appended to a durable, append-only tracking store. 14 weekly pulls on record.

Per-channel share-of-answer. For each AI channel, we count what percent of responses contain a substantive mention or citation of TELUS across the runs in the measurement window. A channel score of 76 means TELUS appears in 76% of that AI's responses to the tracked questions. Directly comparable across channels and across time.

Run counts. Gemini & ChatGPT run 600 responses per 30-day window; Perplexity 600; Google AIO 477; Google AI Mode 476. Different run counts reflect availability windows, not TELUS-side effort.

What this scorecard is not. Not an SEO ranking report. Not a paid-media dashboard. It's a measurement of how each AI channel currently recommends Canadian telco brands, treated as digital-channel operating input for the team that runs channels for TELUS.

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Prepared for **Kim Nguyen** · VP, Digital & Channels · TELUS · September 28, 2026
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